GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

February 13th, 2026
Week 7
Volume 281, Issue 1223

Highlights:

- **Bizarre performance**
- **Ain't that a switch**
- **Bacteria brewing.**
- **CNY hols.**
- **Election boo.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Don't watch the clock; do what it does. Keep going."

– Sam Levenson

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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CONFUSING VALENTINES!

The second week of February brought on a really confusing spin to the markets, with fundamentals across the board performing bizarrely (compared to last week's performance), as after a volatile beginning to the month, the Baltic Exchange Dry Index and even oil futures found steady ground this week, while even the U.S. Dollar firmed against all ship recycling nation currencies except India (ain't that a switch), as did local steel plate prices, which also saw India slip the car into reverse and backpedal nearly all of its recent gains.

In an expanded view, the Baltic Exchange's Dry Bulk Index fell 0.6% this week, pressured primarily by the larger-sized segments, as Capes fell nearly 2% and the Panamax index slipped a matching 0.6%, Supras marched (improved) an impressive 1.8% of their own. Sliding into the barrel, we see WTI crude oil futures pull a drone maneuver and hover around (a lower) USD 62.8/barrel, as markets, investors, and traders collectively worry about the bacteria brewing under the U.S./Iranian nuclear peace carpet once again, and fears over ongoing supply being drastically affected could have a devastating effect on oil prices the world over.

But for the ship recycling world, it's likely to be even quieter as Chine enters its New Year holiday period, an already subdued (in terms of volumes, not price/demand) international ship recycling market is more than likely to be deprived of potential recycling candidates even further. The incoming Year of the Horse hopefully brings with it some better times for the industry, after what has been (and seemingly continues to be) a record low delivery of recycling tonnage over the last several years, and depreciating levels from the highs of USD 600/LDT down to well below USD 400/LDT, have been a jolt to end-of-life residual values of ships and the books of owners/operators.

Recycling markets do seem to have stabilized within the region of the turbulence and for the time being, events are conspiring in favor of sub-continent markets that paint a brighter picture moving forward. The much anticipated (and long overdue) Bangladeshi elections were finally settled this week with an expected victory for the second largest party in the country (behind disgraced and banned former PM Sheikh Hasina's party), as the BNP claimed power with over a 2/3 majority. The Pakistani market remains the firmest for another week as the cheap flood of Iranian imports has ceased for the time being, and Gadani steel plate prices continue to dominate industry levels.

And with currency concerns consuming India's sanity since the start of the year having stabilized this week as well (even showing signs of improvement) and Turkey on the far side slipping back into obscurity after a brief binge of RoRos, overall, it does seem that things couldn't get any worse than they have, and levels may have reached a state of equilibrium for the year (unless something happens). The only thing left is for supply to deliver on its side of the bargain.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 7 of 2026 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

BNP IN!

Election decided.

After what has seemed like an eternity (and then some) of a wait, encouraging political news finally emerged through from the beleaguered Bangladeshi market this week, as the interim student-led regime finally made way for the country's second largest party, the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP), into the leadership seat with more than a 2/3 majority win during the nation's recent General Elections.

Infrastructure hopes.

This (hopefully) means that the long-awaited (and quite frankly, desperately needed) domestic infrastructure projects can finally get off the drawing board and into the national eye, which should ignite domestic construction projects and resume demand for steel once again. While there is likely (more like hopefully, with Trump still at the helm of the global economic reins) to be some increased optimism in the market now that a far more progressive, business-friendly, and locally popular party is finally in charge, reality may have its own say on the matter. Time will tell, eh?

IRRC needed.

Meanwhile, following a request by the government to follow all international HKC regulations, this week also saw the BSBRA adopt the provisions of the International Ready for Recycling Certificate (IRRC), as is also the case now in Pakistan and India. This would mean that once the mandatory IHM Parts I, II, and III have been provided to the ship recycling yard by the Sellers, the relevant recycling yard must then produce a Ship Recycling Plan (SRP), which will then be presented to the class / flag state authorities (once available), in order to produce an IRRC — a fresh requirement for any vessels now arriving any sub-continent ship recycling destination.

Loose belts.

On the fundamentals side, all was not rosy, especially given that the Taka lost 17 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and closed the week out at BDT 122.25, on a trajectory that seems to indicate even more falls next week. Local steel plate prices have, meanwhile refused to leave their hammocks as they continue to flatline at nearly USD 494/ton for nearly 3 weeks now, indicating an utter lack of trade with local steel mills, which itself presents a massive problem for Chattogram yards if they are unable to sell any of the recycled ship's steel.

But that certainly hasn't stopped them from keeping an eye out for the right "type" of unit, as not only did local recyclers manage to reel in another collection of smaller LDT units including a 7K LDT bulker, it was the arrival of a 24K LDT unit that confirmed why Chattogram choppers willingly loosen their belts at the recycling buffets.

As such, despite what has happened/might happen in the nation, the right type/LDT combination of unit will bring a Bangladeshi buyer out of the woodwork and strike a deal.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

CLIFF HANGER!

The Alang market continues to leave the industry on a cliff-hanger, week after week, with vessel prices moving, fundamentals violently shaking the sanity of everyone's innards, and a hungry landscape of ship recyclers who remain on the lookout for tonnage fueled by nothing more than a hefty serving of nervy sentiments and the gravity of hope.

Gravity of hope.

And even though India may be at the bottom of the ship recycling ranking board for yet another week, Alang recyclers have managed to remain quizzically competitive with their neighbors on any of the slim pickings of vessels that do sail onto the bidding tables, as is amply evident by the state of Alang's anchorage this week, where well over 47K LDT is idling / has been delivered to its new owners, including 2 rare large LDT tankers — certainly a sight for hungry eyes.

Steel respite.

From Alang's performance at the bidding tables to the reality on the beaches, one thing is for certain: the ongoing lack of tonnage is seeing the ship recycling fraternity (regardless of destination) reacting rather unexpectedly as they're now seemingly making a dash for the winning line when the right type of unit is tabled. And it's easy to see why.

Fundamentals, meanwhile, continue to rubber-band the local mindset into frenzies after immediate declines, where even this week, we saw local steel plate prices systematically fell nearly USD 10/ton and reversed a majority of its recent gains, all while the Indian Rupee decided heading north was a better option and reclaimed another 15 basis points against the U.S. Dollar, to end the week at Rs. 90.6.

Election hopes.

Overall, the election victory for the BNP in Bangladesh may ease some of the tensions between India and Bangladesh, as a settled and elected party finally takes control, and former disgraced PM Sheikh Hasina, who has been sentenced to death in absentia, continues to live in exile in Delhi despite demands from the Bangladeshi government for her return to face the consequences of her trial, having fled Bangladesh in August 2024.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

PAPA'S HUNGRY!

Stranger things.

Gadani continues to lead the way for yet another week despite an improving Bangladesh narrowing the gap (in the wake of the election victory for the BNP). Yet, the Gadani gang remained comfortable negotiating on (critically) few workable fresh candidates in order to satisfy what has been a corrosive demand fueled by the acidic lack of supply that is only expected to get worse now that the traditionally quieter Chinese New Year holidays are under way. Truth be told, it would have to be a cold day in Lucifer's bathtub for a Chinese-owned unit to be delivered into Gadani, but stranger things have happened, as reality is weirder than fiction.

HKC works.

And other than leading the recycling ranking charts, Pakistan has also been dominating sub-continent currency and steel plate price performances over the last couple of quarters, given that not only has the Pakistani Rupee firmed to below PKR 280, but local steel plate prices even rose recently and have remained atop the industry numbers.

Moreover, this week's performance wrench that affected all markets, managed to keep Pakistan more or less in the clear, as it ended the week just a few basis points weaker at a still healthy PKR 279.59. Local steel plate prices, too, remain even-keeled at an industry-fantastic PKR 594/ton — USD 100/ton more than those from Bangladesh and about USD 190/ton above those from Alang.

Trends

And these improvements, backed by news of numerous local market and private fixtures, saw Gadani's waterfront light up with a series of decent LDT bulk carriers that collectively carried the total volume of tonnage at anchorage to nearly 30K LDT via 4 vessels this week. A massive upgrade for local buyers compared to their silent operating mode over the last several months, where the occasional small LDT vessel would arrive locally, be delayed, and eventually beach.

Finally, HKC infrastructure works also continue at pace in Gadani, with two ship recycling yards now having received their HKC accreditations and upgrades on remaining yards still ongoing and reportedly even making significant progress, as Pakistan may continue to dominate the rankings should the current trends persist.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

OH, ALIAGA!

Give more than just a weakening Lira and the occasional batch of ships that seem to emerge after years. And since Lira is all there ever is, it's down another 24 basis points this week and scratching at the knees of TRY 44, having closed the week at TRY 43.71 against the U.S. Dollar. Local offerings and demand, like the sub-continent, remains lingering and omni-present.

Lingering.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 7 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

ANOTHER…2025 IN REVIEW!!

- *Aug 03: At least 100,000 people marched across the Sydney Harbour Bridge in a pro-Palestine protest.*
- *Aug 11: Fictional girl group HUNTR/X from the Netflix's "KPop Demon Hunters" reached #1 on the U.S. Billboard Hot 100, with their viral song "Golden."*
- *Aug 15: The first-ever World Humanoid Robot Games opened in Beijing, China, featuring over 500 androids from 16 countries.*
- *Aug 28: An AI-enhanced immersive version of the 1939 film The Wizard of Oz premiered at the Sphere in Las Vegas.*
- *Sep 06: Max Verstappen broke the record for the fastest qualifying lap in Formula One history with a time of 1:18.792.*
- *Sep 16: The co-founder of Ben & Jerry's ice cream, Jerry Greenfield, resigned after the parent company, Unilever, limited the brand's activism.*
- *Sep 23: "Jimmy Kimmel Live!" returned to late-night television after ABC briefly suspended the show over Kimmel's comments about the assassination of conservative activist Charlie Kirk.*
- *Sep 25: Former French President Nicolas Sarkozy was sentenced to 5 years in jail for financing his political campaign with funds from Libya.*
- *Oct 03: Taylor Swift released "The Life of a Showgirl," her twelfth studio album.*
- *Oct 07: The price of gold on the New York Mercantile Exchange reached $4,000.00 an ounce for the first time.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 04 – Holi March 21 – Eid-ul-Fitr (subj. to Moon sighting) March 26 – Ram Navami March 31 – Mahavir Jayanthi	February 16 – February 23 March 01 – March 07 March 18 – March 24

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
February 21 – Martyr's Day March 19 – Eid-ul-Fitr March 20 – March 23 – Jumatul Bidah + Eid Day 2 & 3 March 26 – Independence Day	February 19 – February 22 March 04 – March 07 March 19 – March 22

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
March 21 – March 23 – Eid-ul-Fitr Days 1, 2, & 3	March 19 – March 23 - Eid-ul-Fitr & Ramzan Bayrami

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ALANG - Port Position as of February 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Diana	15,065	Oil Tanker	Arrived February 13
2	Dimple	4,869	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 13
3	*J M A*	*2,505*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered February 10*
4	*Saltlake*	*2,127*	*Reefer*	*Delivered February 10*
5	*Woodchip*	*22,800*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered February 06*
Morality		**47,366**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of February 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Beihai	24,181	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 10
2	Chung	3,551	Cement Carrier	Arrived February 07
3	Hansung	2,731	RoRo	Arrived February 05
4	Sirrah	7,072	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 13
		37,534		

GADANI - Port Position as of February 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Bright Ace	2,573	General Cargo	Arrived February 10
2	Jimei Fuhao	9,881	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 05
3	Rui Tiger	10,198	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 07
4	Sheng Le	6,961	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 04
Total Tonnage		**29,612**		

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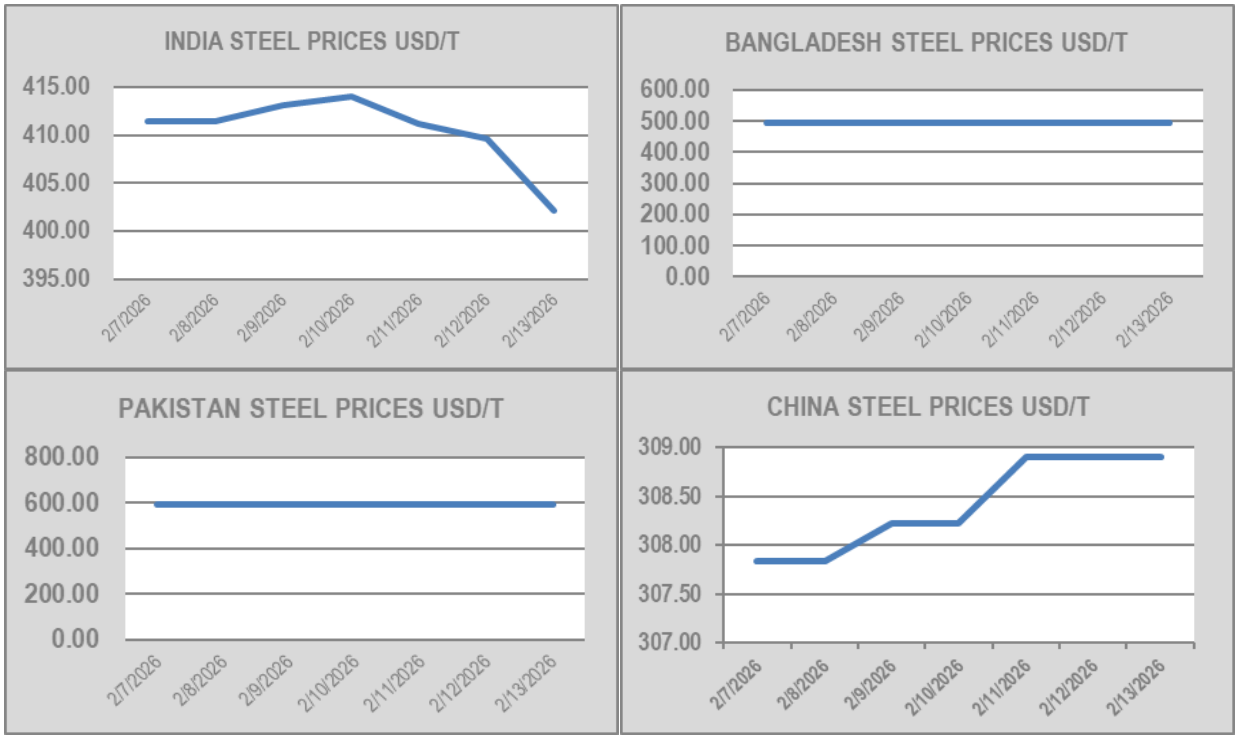
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
2/7/2026	411.43	37,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84
2/8/2026	411.43	37,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	307.84
2/9/2026	413.18	37,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	308.23
2/10/2026	414.00	37,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	308.23
2/11/2026	411.25	37,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	308.91
2/12/2026	409.58	37,100.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	308.91
2/13/2026	402.20	36,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	308.91



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